Engineering On-Call Policy

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1. Rotation

Each production service has a primary and a secondary on-call engineer. Rotations last one week, from Monday 10:00 AM to the following Monday 10:00 AM Pacific Time. Engineers join the rotation after completing on-call training and shadowing one full rotation. Nobody may be primary on-call more than one week in four.

2. Expectations

The primary on-call must acknowledge pages within 5 minutes and be able to start working within 15 minutes, at any hour. If the primary does not acknowledge within 10 minutes, PagerDuty escalates to the secondary, and after 20 minutes to the Engineering Manager.

3. Compensation

Engineers receive an on-call stipend of $300 per week as primary and $150 per week as secondary. Engineers who are paged between 10:00 PM and 7:00 AM may take the following morning off, without using PTO.

4. Handoff

At the end of each rotation the outgoing primary writes a handoff note in #oncall-handoff listing open incidents, noisy alerts, and anything the next person should watch.